With that lifeline, I managed to hit the winning runs just before the rains came. I spoke to Rudi about the incident years later and he just laughed, claiming – as I'm sure he would to this day – that he'd never heard a nick. I don't see how that's possible, though. It was as loud a nick as it gets … and as far as I know, Rudi's hearing is pretty top-notch. With his retirement earlier this year, international cricket lost a great umpire.

So ja, to get back to where I started about umpiring … I think the game would be more boring and less quirky without the human element the umpires bring to it. Perhaps we need to keep the technology but make it available to the umpire only. And if he's not sure, then he can go upstairs if he so chooses.

ME

Regrets, I have a few

Looking back on my cricketing career, I have very few regrets about not achieving on-field goals. If I had to pick one, though, it would be that I would have liked to have been a bit more expressive … a bit more attacking, especially in Test cricket. Remember how Brian Lara climbed into Robbie Peterson during the first Test of the West Indies 2003/04 tour to South Africa? He smacked 28 runs off that one over. I should've been more of an out-and-out attacking Test batsman like Lara and India's current opener, Virender Sehwag.

But, as I've touched on, the Proteas' approach to the game is not exactly conducive to playing this kind of attacking cricket. Our approach has always been conservative, no matter what might've been said in the press. If you hit a couple of fours in an over, you're expected to block out the rest of it. Jacques Kallis's comments during my 'six sixes' over against the Netherlands in the 2007 World Cup prove my point. I'm not having a go at Jacques, but his words reflect how we've been taught to play.

Then Proteas coach Mickey Arthur, for example, always told us that the first 20 balls in an ODI should be used to play ourselves in. I'd think, '*Twenty* balls? If you said that to Hayden or Gilchrist, they'd tell you to piss right off.' Do you think those Aussie batsmen ever thought, 'Yeah mate, tell you what, let's just block out the first 20 and then take it from there, shall we?' No. Exactly. Unfortunately, though, that's the sort of mindset we've had, and frankly, I've always thought it to be utter bullshit.